

Problem 3 (20 points). Here are some words in Middle Persian written in the Book Pahlavi script:

𐭮𐭥𐭥𐭥 A	𐭥𐭥𐭥 B	𐭥𐭥 C	𐭥𐭥𐭥 D	𐭥𐭥𐭥 E	𐭥𐭥𐭥 F
𐭮𐭥𐭥 G	𐭮𐭥𐭥 H	𐭮𐭥𐭥 I	𐭮𐭥 J	𐭮𐭥 K	𐭮𐭥 L
𐭮𐭥 M	𐭮𐭥 N	𐭮𐭥 O	𐭮𐭥 P	𐭮𐭥 Q	𐭮𐭥 R
𐭮𐭥 S	𐭮𐭥 T	𐭮𐭥 U	𐭮𐭥 V	𐭮𐭥 W	𐭮𐭥 X
𐭮𐭥 Y	𐭮𐭥 Z	𐭮𐭥 AA	𐭮𐭥 BB	𐭮𐭥 CC	𐭮𐭥 DD

Scholars employ two systems of rendering Middle Persian words using Roman characters. The system that reflects the Pahlavi spelling is called *scientific transliteration*. In turn, the system that represents the tentative pronunciation of the words is called *transcription*.

Some words could be spelt in multiple ways in the Pahlavi script. For example, the word *dīdan* 'to see' could be alternatively spelt as 𐭮𐭥𐭥𐭥 (scientific transliteration: **HZYTNW-tn'**) or as 𐭮𐭥𐭥 (scientific transliteration: **dytn'**).

(a) Match each word above with its scientific transliteration and transcription. Note that the words written in the Pahlavi script may correspond to multiple Middle Persian words.

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|------------|---------|----------|---------------|-----------|--------------------------|
| 1. 𐭮𐭥𐭥 | āsrōn | priest | 18. whʔl | wahār | spring (season) |
| 2. sydʔ | syā | black | 19. APLA | xāk | earth, dust |
| 3. DMYA | xōn | blood | 20. gwn' | gōn | colour |
| 4. AHTE | xwāh | sister | 21. LCDr' | tar | over, through, across |
| 5. blbwʔ' | barbut | lyre | 22. mng | mang | henbane (type of plant) |
| 6. gyʔh | giyāh | grass | 23. lwlk' | rūrag | medicinal plant, herb |
| 7. ALBA | čāhār | four | 24. ZWZN' | drahm | drachm (unit of weight) |
| 8. dwt' | dūd | smoke | 25. dlmnk' | dramanag | wormwood (type of plant) |
| 9. mwd | mōy | hair | 26. NKSWN-tn' | kuštan | to kill |
| 10. gdk' | gēg | thief | 27. ʔwzmbwlt' | uzumburd | emerald |
| 11. hmyšk' | hamēšag | always | 28. glmwk' | garmōg | warm, hot |
| 12. LK | tō | thou | 29. ʔhlmn' | Ahremen | the evil spirit |
| 13. gwkl't | gōgird | sulphur | 30. ʔylʔnštr' | Ērān-šahr | land of the Aryans |
| 14. wʔcʔl | wāzār | market | 31. ywdtʔk' | judāg | separate, different |
| 15. MLKTA | bāmbišn | queen | 32. dhšk' | daxšag | mark, sign; memory |
| 16. HZWLYA | hūg | pig | 33. nhʔl | nihāl | sapling, young tree |
| 17. zwzk' | zūzag | hedgehog | 34. lwcynk' | lawzēnag | almond sweetmeat |

(b) In Book Pahlavi, one Middle Persian word is usually written with a certain graphic peculiarity. Identify this word.

(c) The following words are alternative spellings of some of the words above.

EE. 𐭮𐭥𐭥𐭥 FF. 𐭮𐭥𐭥 GG. 𐭮𐭥𐭥 HH. 𐭮𐭥𐭥 II. 𐭮𐭥𐭥 JJ. 𐭮𐭥𐭥

Identify them and provide their scientific transliterations.

Seventeenth International Linguistics Olympiad (2019)
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(d) Write in the Book Pahlavi script:

KK.	DKRA	<i>muy</i>	<i>date-palm</i>
LL.	dlwnd	<i>druwand</i>	<i>evil, sinful, unrighteous</i>
MM.	stwl	<i>stōr</i>	<i>horse</i>
NN.	cmbI	<i>čambar</i>	<i>circle, hoop</i>

(!) No additional explanation besides the answers is required, nor will be marked.

⚠ Middle Persian belongs to the Iranian branch of the Indo-European family. It was spoken in the Sasanian Empire and survived through centuries as a written language, especially in translations of the Zoroastrian canon.

The transcription used here corresponds to the reconstructed pronunciation of the 3rd century CE. The mark $\bar{}$ indicates that the vowel is long. $\check{c} = ch$ in *church*; $h = h$ in *hat*; $\check{j} = j$ in *judge*; $\check{s} = sh$ in *sheesh*; $w = w$ in *win*; $x \approx ch$ in Scottish *loch*; y like x but voiced; $y = y$ in *yum*; $z = z$ in *zigzag*.

Knowledge of Modern Iranian languages is irrelevant for solving this problem.

—*André Nikulin (consultant: Miguel Ángel Andrés Toledo)*